

it were dug up before. The appearance of rotten logs can be attributed to trees falling. Another pit of similar description had been discovered in the surrounding area which lends credence to the natural phenomena theory.

Kryptos

Kryptos is an encrypted sculpture by Jim Sanborn, who is also the creator of the Cyrillic Projector, located on the grounds of Central Intelligence in Langley, Virginia. The sculpture has been made with four copper plates and other elements such as granite, quartz and wood. There has been speculation about the encrypted message it bears. The name comes from the Greek meaning 'hidden' which signifies the theme of the sculpture, intelligence gathering. The main sculpture consists of four separate enigmatic messages. Three of them have since been cracked. The sculpture was installed in 1990. The first three parts were solved by an NSA analyst in 1992. Notably, a CIA analyst was able to crack the code using pencil and paper techniques. The fourth part is yet to be solved and is one of the most notoriously famous unsolved ciphers in the world. Since 2003, an active Yahoo group coordinates the work of over 2,000 members to decrypt the final sculpture.



Kryptos

Hint for enthusiastic readers: The answer to the first part contains the clue to the final part.

Vigenère cipher

The main problem with simple substitution ciphers is that they are susceptible to frequency analysis. Provided we have a sufficiently large cipher text it can be broken by comparing the frequency of its letters to that of letters in different languages. The aim for cryptographers was therefore to make encryption techniques that were immune to frequency analysis. A common approach is to suppress the frequency data using more than one alphabet to encrypt the data. The Vigenère cipher is one such method which is a simple form of polyalphabetic substitutions.

The method was originally developed in the 16th century but was later misattributed to Blaise de Vigenère and is now known as the Vigenère